

GED Social Studies Practice Test 4

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC4-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state legislature passes a law requiring every new rule created by a state agency to be published online for 30 days before it takes effect. During that time, residents, businesses, and community groups may submit written comments. Agency officials must review the comments and explain major changes before the final rule is adopted.

Which purpose is best supported by this process?

- A) To remove courts from reviewing government action
- B) To increase public input and accountability in rulemaking
- C) To allow agencies to pass criminal laws without limits
- D) To give private companies control over state budgets

GED-SOC4-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A grocery store tracks weekly demand for bottled water during a heat wave.

Week: 1, 2, 3

Average temperature: 82°F, 91°F, 96°F

Cases sold: 340, 510, 680

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Demand for bottled water increased as temperatures rose.
- B) Demand for bottled water decreased as temperatures rose.
- C) Temperature had no relationship to bottled water sales.
- D) Bottled water sales stayed the same each week.

GED-SOC4-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

At the Constitutional Convention, delegates from large states supported representation in Congress based on population. Delegates from smaller states feared that this system would leave them with little influence. A compromise created a House of Representatives based on population and a Senate with equal representation for each state.

Which issue did this compromise address?

- A) How enslaved people would gain immediate citizenship
- B) How states of different sizes would be represented in Congress
- C) How the president would appoint state governors
- D) How courts would collect taxes from farmers

GED-SOC4-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A river delta has fertile soil and supports rice farming, fishing, and several large towns. However, seasonal floods can damage homes and roads. Local officials are considering stronger levees and better evacuation routes.

Which statement best explains the geographic situation?

- A) River deltas can provide resources while also creating flood risks.
- B) River deltas are always too dry for farming.
- C) Flooding prevents all settlement near rivers.
- D) Fertile soil has no effect on where people live.

GED-SOC4-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state ballot initiative would allow voters to approve or reject a proposed tax for park improvements. Supporters collect signatures to place the measure on the ballot. Opponents argue against the tax at public forums before election day.

Which TWO statements best describe this situation?

- A) Citizens are participating directly in a policy decision.
- B) Public debate allows voters to hear arguments before deciding.
- C) Courts are replacing voters in making tax policy.
- D) The president is using commander in chief powers.
- E) Voting is not involved in the decision.

GED-SOC4-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A member of Congress argues that national standards for air pollution are necessary because

polluted air can cross state lines. The member says that one state's weak rules may harm residents in neighboring states.

Source B:

A state official argues that local industries and geography differ widely, so state governments should have flexibility in setting environmental rules. The official says that state agencies understand local conditions better than distant federal agencies.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether pollution exists at all
- B) Whether environmental regulation should be mainly national or state-controlled
- C) Whether courts should be abolished
- D) Whether citizens should be allowed to vote

GED-SOC4-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1830s, the federal government forced several Native nations to leave their homelands in the Southeast and move west of the Mississippi River. Supporters claimed the policy would open land for settlement. Many Native people suffered from disease, hunger, and loss of community during the forced removal.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) Federal expansion policies could bring severe consequences for Native peoples.
- B) Native nations controlled all federal land policy during the 1830s.
- C) Forced removal improved living conditions for all Native communities.
- D) Westward expansion ended before the Mississippi River was reached.

GED-SOC4-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A person who becomes a U.S. citizen through the legal process of naturalization gains the [D1] and accepts the [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) right to vote in most elections | power to appoint federal judges | right to declare war

D2) responsibilities of citizenship | power to rewrite state constitutions | authority to veto laws

GED-SOC4-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A worker earns \$18 per hour and works 35 hours in one week. How much does the worker earn

before taxes?

Type your answer as a dollar amount without the dollar sign.

GED-SOC4-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A semi-arid farming region has experienced repeated droughts. Overgrazing and removal of trees have exposed soil to wind erosion. Farmers report that once-productive fields are becoming less fertile.

Which geographic process is most clearly described?

- A) Desertification
- B) Urban renewal
- C) Cultural assimilation
- D) Maritime trade

GED-SOC4-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A president signs a treaty with another country. Before the treaty can take full legal effect for the United States, the Senate must vote on whether to approve it.

Which constitutional principle is illustrated by this requirement?

- A) Checks and balances
- B) Trial by jury
- C) Local zoning
- D) Direct initiative

GED-SOC4-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows immigration through one major U.S. entry port.

Year: 1880, 1890, 1900

Immigrants processed: 120,000, 310,000, 455,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Immigration through the port increased from 1880 to 1900.
- B) Immigration through the port decreased each decade.
- C) Immigration was highest in 1880.
- D) No immigrants were processed in 1890.

GED-SOC4-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

The Constitution gives Congress the power to regulate commerce among the states. This power has been used to create national rules for certain business activities that cross state lines, such as transportation, shipping, and some workplace standards.

Which power is described in the source?

- A) Interstate commerce power
- B) Power to appoint governors
- C) Power to issue marriage licenses
- D) Power to conduct local school board elections

GED-SOC4-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city raises the parking fee downtown. Some drivers begin using buses or parking farther away. Business owners near the center worry that fewer customers will visit if parking becomes too expensive.

Which economic idea is best illustrated?

- A) People often respond to incentives and costs.
- B) Higher prices never change behavior.
- C) Scarcity applies only to natural resources.
- D) Public fees cannot affect private decisions.

GED-SOC4-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A person held in jail asks a court to review whether the government has a lawful reason for holding them. The court orders officials to explain the detention. If officials cannot provide a lawful basis, the person may be released.

Which protection is described?

- A) Habeas corpus
- B) Eminent domain
- C) Cabinet privilege
- D) Reserved powers

GED-SOC4-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

In the late 1800s, many farmers argued that railroad companies charged unfair shipping rates and that tight credit made it hard to repay loans. Some farmers joined political movements that called for railroad regulation, currency reform, and greater government attention to rural economic problems.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Farmers organized politically to respond to economic pressures.
- B) Transportation costs affected farmers' ability to reach markets.
- C) Farmers wanted to eliminate all national elections.
- D) Railroad companies had no connection to agricultural markets.
- E) Rural economic problems ended before farmers organized.

GED-SOC4-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country reports the following age distribution.

Age group: 0–14, 15–64, 65+

Share of population: 24%, 61%, 15%

Which age group makes up the largest share of the population?

- A) 0–14
- B) 15–64
- C) 65+
- D) 0–14 and 65+ equally

GED-SOC4-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state passes a law banning a peaceful march because officials disagree with the marchers' message. A court rules that the state cannot ban the march only because the message is unpopular.

Which constitutional principle is most closely connected to the ruling?

- A) Government may not restrict peaceful assembly simply because it dislikes a viewpoint.
- B) State governments may cancel all public gatherings at any time.
- C) Only elected officials may express political views.
- D) The right to assemble applies only to private homes.

GED-SOC4-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A household tracks monthly electricity bills.

Month: June, July, August

Electricity bill: \$110, \$143, \$154

By how many dollars did the bill increase from June to August?

A) \$33

B) \$44

C) \$110

D) \$264

GED-SOC4-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A mayor proposes a budget, but the city council must approve spending. This shows [D1] because power is divided between [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) checks and balances | naturalization | judicial review

D2) executive and legislative officials | federal judges and juries | foreign diplomats and ambassadors

GED-SOC4-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county reports the number of residents who used public services in one month.

Service: Job training, Health clinic, Legal aid, Housing office

Residents served: 260, 415, 130, 295

How many residents used these services in total?

A) 970

B) 1,000

C) 1,100

D) 1,250

GED-SOC4-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In the early 1900s, some journalists investigated crowded tenements, unsafe factories, child labor, and corruption in city governments. Their reports often shocked readers and increased pressure for reform.

Which statement best explains the role of these journalists?

- A) They exposed social and political problems to encourage public action.
- B) They ended all industrial employment immediately.
- C) They argued that cities had no problems to solve.
- D) They prevented voters from learning about government.

GED-SOC4-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city's population grew from 240,000 to 300,000. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC4-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A federal judge is appointed for life during good behavior rather than for a short elected term. Supporters argue that this helps judges make decisions based on law instead of fear of losing an election.

Which idea is best reflected in this arrangement?

- A) Judicial independence
- B) Direct democracy
- C) Legislative apportionment
- D) Popular initiative

GED-SOC4-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Petition
- B) Assembly
- C) Due process
- D) Free press

Targets:

- T1) People gather peacefully to express a public concern.
- T2) A person receives fair legal procedures before punishment.
- T3) Residents ask government officials to change a policy.

GED-SOC4-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A town has a limited budget for public safety. Officials can hire more firefighters, buy new emergency radios, or repair an old fire station. They choose the radios because emergency communication has failed several times.

Which statement best describes the decision?

- A) The town is making a choice among competing uses of limited resources.
- B) The town has unlimited resources for every public safety project.
- C) Scarcity affects only individuals, not governments.
- D) The town can avoid opportunity cost by choosing one option.

GED-SOC4-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A worker moves from one country to another and sends part of each paycheck back to relatives. The money helps the relatives pay school fees, repair their home, and buy food.

What are these payments called?

- A) Remittances
- B) Tariffs
- C) Amendments
- D) Monopolies

GED-SOC4-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city council member argues, "Before we approve this contract, we should require a public vote by the full council, publish the contract terms, and allow residents to ask questions. Even a good project needs a clear process so the public can trust the result."

Which claim is best supported by the statement?

- A) Open procedures can help build public trust in government decisions.
- B) Public contracts should always be secret.
- C) Residents should not be allowed to question officials.
- D) City councils cannot vote on public contracts.

GED-SOC4-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

During the Harlem Renaissance, writers, musicians, and artists produced work that celebrated African American culture and challenged stereotypes. Many works also reflected the experience of migration, urban life, and continuing discrimination.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) Cultural expression became a way to explore identity and social conditions.
- B) African American artists avoided public life during the period.
- C) The movement focused only on agricultural technology.
- D) Migration had no influence on cultural change.

GED-SOC4-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state committee reviewed public comments on a transportation plan.

Position: Support, Oppose, Suggest changes

Comments: 1,250, 950, 300

What percentage of the 2,500 total comments supported the plan?

- A) 30%
- B) 38%
- C) 50%
- D) 75%

GED-SOC4-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A citizen receives a notice to appear for jury service. The notice explains that juries help ensure that legal decisions are not made only by government officials.

Which civic idea is best reflected?

- A) Citizens can participate directly in the justice system.
- B) Citizens may appoint Supreme Court justices.
- C) Jury service replaces the need for written laws.
- D) Only elected officials may decide court cases.

GED-SOC4-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A city election office reported turnout by voting method.

Voting method: Election Day, Early in-person, Mail ballot, Provisional ballot

Ballots counted: 18,400, 12,600, 9,800, 200

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Election Day voting had the most ballots counted.
- B) Mail ballots were more numerous than early in-person ballots.
- C) Provisional ballots had the fewest ballots counted.
- D) Early in-person and mail ballots together totaled 22,400.
- E) The total number of ballots counted was 18,400.

GED-SOC4-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A government official is accused of awarding a public contract to a company owned by a close relative. Investigators review whether the official used public power for private benefit.

Which civic concern is most directly involved?

- A) Conflict of interest
- B) Naturalization
- C) Popular sovereignty
- D) Apportionment

GED-SOC4-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows the percentage of households with home radios.

Year: 1925, 1930, 1940

Households with radios: 10%, 40%, 82%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Radio ownership expanded greatly between 1925 and 1940.
- B) Radio ownership declined every year listed.
- C) No households had radios by 1940.
- D) Radio ownership was higher in 1925 than in 1930.

GED-SOC4-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A public school may set reasonable rules for when and where student clubs meet, but it may not deny a club access only because officials dislike the club's viewpoint. School rules must be applied fairly to similar groups.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) Government institutions must apply rules fairly and avoid viewpoint discrimination.
- B) Public schools may ban any club without a reason.
- C) Students lose every constitutional protection at school.
- D) Viewpoint discrimination is required by the Constitution.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC4-001 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: To increase public input and accountability in rulemaking — Explanation: Publishing proposed rules and requiring comments gives the public a chance to review and respond before rules take effect.

GED-SOC4-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Demand for bottled water increased as temperatures rose. — Explanation: The table shows temperatures rising from 82°F to 96°F while sales increased from 340 to 680 cases.

GED-SOC4-003 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: How states of different sizes would be represented in Congress — Explanation: The compromise balanced population-based representation in the House with equal state representation in the Senate.

GED-SOC4-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: River deltas can provide resources while also creating flood risks. — Explanation: The delta supports farming and fishing but also creates risks from seasonal flooding.

GED-SOC4-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Citizens are participating directly in a policy decision. | Public debate allows voters to hear arguments before deciding. — Explanation: The ballot initiative and forums show direct participation and public discussion before a vote.

GED-SOC4-006 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Whether environmental regulation should be mainly national or state-controlled — Explanation: Source A favors national standards, while Source B emphasizes state flexibility.

GED-SOC4-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Federal expansion policies could bring severe consequences for Native peoples. — Explanation: The source describes forced removal and the suffering of Native communities.

GED-SOC4-008 — Correct: D1=right to vote in most elections; D2=responsibilities of citizenship — Correct Answer: D1=right to vote in most elections; D2=responsibilities of citizenship — Explanation: Naturalized citizens gain key rights and accept civic responsibilities.

GED-SOC4-009 — Correct: 630 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 630 — Explanation: $\$18 \times 35 \text{ hours} = \630 .

GED-SOC4-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Desertification — Explanation: Repeated drought, overgrazing, tree removal, and soil erosion can cause productive land to become less fertile.

GED-SOC4-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Checks and balances — Explanation: The Senate's treaty approval power checks the president's role in making treaties.

GED-SOC4-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Immigration through the port increased from 1880 to 1900. — Explanation: The number rose from 120,000 to 310,000 to 455,000.

GED-SOC4-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Interstate commerce power — Explanation: The source describes Congress regulating commerce among the states.

GED-SOC4-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: People often respond to incentives and costs. — Explanation: Higher parking fees influence drivers' choices and may affect nearby businesses.

GED-SOC4-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Habeas corpus — Explanation: Habeas corpus allows a court to review whether a person is being lawfully detained.

GED-SOC4-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Farmers organized politically to respond to economic pressures. | Transportation costs affected farmers' ability to reach markets. — Explanation: The description shows farmers responding to railroad rates, credit issues, and market access problems.

GED-SOC4-017 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: 15–64 — Explanation: The 15–64 age group is 61%, the largest share.

GED-SOC4-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government may not restrict peaceful assembly simply because it dislikes a viewpoint. — Explanation: The court protects peaceful assembly from viewpoint-based government restriction.

GED-SOC4-019 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: \$44 — Explanation: \$154 minus \$110 equals a \$44 increase.

GED-SOC4-020 — Correct: D1=checks and balances; D2=executive and legislative officials — Correct Answer: D1=checks and balances; D2=executive and legislative officials — Explanation: The mayor proposes a budget, while the council checks that authority by approving spending.

GED-SOC4-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 1,100 — Explanation: $260 + 415 + 130 + 295 = 1,100$.

GED-SOC4-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: They exposed social and political problems to encourage public action. — Explanation: Investigative journalists reported on problems that increased pressure for reform.

GED-SOC4-023 — Correct: 25 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 25 — Explanation: The increase is 60,000; 60,000 divided by 240,000 equals 25%.

GED-SOC4-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Judicial independence — Explanation: Life tenure during good behavior helps judges decide cases without election pressure.

GED-SOC4-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=C; T3=A — Correct Answer: T1=Assembly; T2=Due process; T3=Petition — Explanation: Assembly means peaceful gathering, due process means fair legal procedures, and petition means asking government for change.

GED-SOC4-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The town is making a choice among competing uses of limited resources. — Explanation: The town must choose one use for limited public safety funds.

GED-SOC4-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Remittances — Explanation: Remittances are money sent by migrants or workers to people in another place, often family members.

GED-SOC4-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Open procedures can help build public trust in government decisions. — Explanation: The statement supports public voting, published terms, and resident questions to make decisions more trustworthy.

GED-SOC4-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Cultural expression became a way to explore identity and social conditions. — Explanation: The source says the Harlem Renaissance celebrated culture and addressed migration, urban life, and discrimination.

GED-SOC4-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 50% — Explanation: 1,250 supporting comments out of 2,500 total comments equals 50%.

GED-SOC4-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Citizens can participate directly in the justice system. — Explanation: Jury service allows citizens to help decide legal matters.

GED-SOC4-032 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: Election Day voting had the most ballots counted. | Provisional ballots had the fewest ballots counted. — Explanation: Election Day had 18,400 ballots, the highest number, while provisional ballots had 200, the lowest.

GED-SOC4-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Conflict of interest — Explanation: The official may have used public authority to benefit a relative's company.

GED-SOC4-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Radio ownership expanded greatly between 1925 and 1940. — Explanation: Household radio ownership increased from 10% to 82%.

GED-SOC4-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government institutions must apply rules fairly and avoid viewpoint discrimination. — Explanation: The source says public school rules must be applied fairly and cannot deny access only because of viewpoint.